

FILM REVIEWS

KARTHIK CALLING KARTHIK
Wrong Number

RATING ★ ★ ★ ☆ ☆

Director: Vijay Lalwani
Starring: Farhan Akhtar,
 Deepika Padukone

Why do all troubled, but intelligent
 heroes in Bollywood play with the

Rubik's cube? Why are
 all independent-
 minded working girls
 shown to be Ben-
 gali? Why do no
 Bollywood
 women make
 passes at
 guys who
 wear
 glasses?
 Why does
 Deepika Padukone
PADUKONE AND AKHTAR

sport only one expression on her face? None of these questions will be answered when you watch *Karthik Calling Karthik*, an attempt to make what Bollywood would call a thinking thriller. Tone deaf performances from the lead pair do nothing to help a script that tries to delve into the mind of a schizophrenic, and while there's a brief flurry of excitement at seeing Farhan Akhtar smarten up and get the girl, it's lost in the clichés that abound. The production design is pretty as a picture and young people go to nightclubs, smoke, drink and even have pre-marital sex, but a trip that takes you inside Karthik's troubled soul? That explains the depths of a disorder that causes him to try to do harm to himself? Nah. Bollywood is so happy having discovered interesting disorders, from progeria to Asperger's Syndrome, that it cannot go beyond the superficial. Misery has to look good to make us feel good. But here, it's just a wrong number. **KB**

TEEN PATTI
Card Warped

RATING ★ ☆ ☆ ☆ ☆

Director: Leena Yadav
Starring: Amitabh Bachchan,
 Ben Kingsley

A mathematician who tests his theory of probability on a card game, enough of a story allowing Amitabh Bachchan to display his entire dramatic range. Appearances by Ben Kingsley, Barry John, Saira Mohan and half of the producer's celebrity Mumbai friends. But to what end? Yes, Bachchan still delivers magical soliloquies and Kingsley and John are very stiff



upper lip even when they speak Hindi. But a supporting cast of highly unattractive players and lines that creak of script manufacturing workshops ("You have to live it to learn it") make the film an excruciating waste of talent, time and money. "Jeetne ke liye harna zaroori hai"? Yes, but avoiding this film is even more necessary. **KB**

FESTIVAL

Soulful Revelry

The Indira Gandhi National Centre for the Arts is organising a four-day event, The Gharana Festival from March 12 in Delhi. The line-up includes Pandit Laxman Krishnarao of the Gwalior Gharana, Girija Devi of the Banaras Gharana and Subhra Guha of the Agra Gharana. Be there for a soulful musical rendezvous. On till March 15.

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